



INTERNATIONAL AEROSPACE EXHIBITION
'INDIA AVIATION 2010' AT HYDERABAD

Photographs by A PRABHAKAR RAO/www.indiatodayimages.com

Major on its board as the national carrier jettisons its ageing fleet to state-of-the-art aircraft.

Other carriers, meanwhile, are adding aircraft and new destinations to their network. Paramount Airways, which is already flying across the country, is set to go global by the end of the year or early in 2011. For a start, it will fly to Singapore, Kuala Lumpur and Bangkok. "We are getting ten A321 aircraft of which five will be delivered this year," says managing director M. Thiagarajan. SpiceJet, which operates a fleet of 19 Boeing 737s, will induct nine more aircraft by 2012 and expand its operations to Sri Lanka, Maldives and Nepal. Indigo is also in similar mode. "Our fleet will be up from 25 to 40 by 2012. We are focusing on increasing the frequency from existing destinations rather than add new ones," says Indigo President Aditya Ghosh.

Business jet makers have also rolled out ambitious plans. Bombardier Aerospace hopes to deliver 250 business jets in the next 20 years and is opening its fifth support office abroad in Mumbai after Tokyo, Sydney, Shanghai and Munich. Russian United Aviation Corporation

Wings of Change

With 69 airlines from 49 nations flying into India, international passengers will grow up to 50 million by 2015. Here is how the various arms of the Indian aviation sector are gearing up to meet the requirements of the next decade.

Planes

Ageing and leased planes will be replaced with new, more fuel-efficient ones. India will require 1,092 large aircraft valued at \$138 billion in the next 20 years. The orders so far:

Air India (NACIL): One A320 and another A321 by April, 33 Boeings to follow.

Indigo: 71 A320s; nine to be added before December.

Kingfisher: 67 to be added to its A320 and A321 fleet, may include B777s.

Jet Airways: 57, including five A330s, three B777s, 20 B787s and 39 B737s.

SpiceJet: Nine Boeing 737s by 2012.

Paramount Airways: 10 A321s, five by December.



Helicopters

Number to be doubled from 268 in a few years. Chopper corridors are to come up at Mumbai and Delhi airports to ease congestion.

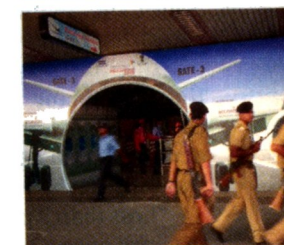
Eurocopter: 15 for corporate clients to add to 76 that fly now.

Two new joint ventures, AugustaWestland-Tata Motors and Sikorsky Aircraft Corporation-Tata Advanced Systems, to make choppers at their new facilities in Hyderabad.



Airports

35 non-metro airports are to be upgraded and modernised by 2012 at a cost of Rs 4,662 crore.



MRO and Testing Services

Maintenance, repair and overhaul besides testing services are going to be a \$2.6-billion business by 2020.

NACIL and GE Aviation will jointly offer support and engine servicing of GENx-1B engine in Mumbai to generate Rs 3,000 crore in three to five years, tapping Chinese, Japanese and Gulf airlines.

Boeing to build a \$100-million 50-acre facility in Nagpur; **GMR Group** with Malaysian Airlines to set up a MRO facility in Hyderabad; **Eurocopter** with Pawan Hans will come up with their facility in Mumbai or Delhi and **Indocon** in Bhubaneswar.



Training

Airbus Training India, Bangalore, to train up to 1,000 pilots a year for Airbus aircraft that represent 65 per cent of India's fleet.

